

STATE OF NEW YORK

1621--A

2025-2026 Regular Sessions

IN ASSEMBLY

January 10, 2025

Introduced by M. of A. ROSENTHAL, DINOWITZ, TAYLOR, DAVILA, REYES, VALDEZ, TAPIA, GALLAGHER, SHRESTHA, McDONALD, SIMON, RAGA, GONZALEZ-ROJAS, BURDICK, LEVENBERG, BICHOTTE HERMELYN, MORENO, STECK, HOOKS -- Multi-Sponsored by -- M. of A. COLTON, GLICK -- read once and referred to the Committee on Housing -- recommitted to the Committee on Housing in accordance with Assembly Rule 3, sec. 2 -- committee discharged, bill amended, ordered reprinted as amended and recommitted to said committee

AN ACT to amend the real property actions and proceedings law, in relation to conditions precedent to the bringing of certain actions or proceedings

The People of the State of New York, represented in Senate and Assembly, do enact as follows:

Section 1. Subdivisions 1 and 2 of section 711 of the real property actions and proceedings law, subdivision 1 as amended by chapter 305 of the laws of 1963 and subdivision 2 as amended by section 4 of part HH of chapter 56 of the laws of 2024, are amended to read as follows:

1. (a) The tenant continues in possession of any portion of the premises after the expiration of [~~his~~] such tenant's term, without the permission of the landlord or, in a case where a new lessee is entitled to possession, without the permission of the new lessee, providing that, in all proceedings that are not subject to paragraph (f) of this subdivision herein, at the time of commencement of the proceeding, there are no violations of record of any applicable state, city or local codes relating to housing maintenance, safety or housing standards pertaining to the subject premises or in the common areas of the subject building, nor any conditions that otherwise contravene section two hundred thirty-five-b of the real property law in the subject premises or in the common areas of the subject building, nor any tenant declaration of housing conditions declaring conditions that contravene section two hundred thirty-five-b of the real property law or that violate any

EXPLANATION--Matter in italics (underscored) is new; matter in brackets [~~-~~] is old law to be omitted.

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1 applicable state, city or local codes relating to housing maintenance,
2 safety or housing standards, in the subject premises or in the common
3 areas of the subject building or that are hazardous conditions in any
4 building in the landlord's portfolio subject to paragraph (b) of this
5 subdivision herein, nor any conditions that are hazardous violations of
6 any applicable state, city or local codes relating to housing mainte-
7 nance, safety or housing standards or hazardous violations in any build-
8 ing in the landlord's portfolio. Acceptance of rent after commencement
9 of the special proceeding upon this ground shall not terminate such
10 proceeding nor effect any award of possession to the landlord or to the
11 new lessee, as the case may be. A proceeding seeking to recover
12 possession of real property by reason of the termination of the term
13 fixed in the lease pursuant to a provision contained therein giving the
14 landlord the right to terminate the time fixed for occupancy under such
15 agreement if ~~he~~ the landlord deem the tenant objectionable, shall not
16 be maintainable unless the landlord shall by competent evidence estab-
17 lish to the satisfaction of the court that the tenant is objectionable.

18 (b) Where a tenant declaration of housing conditions has been filed
19 with the landlord and the court that is the lawful venue for a special
20 proceeding under this subdivision, or where there exist any violations
21 of record of any applicable state, city or local codes relating to hous-
22 ing maintenance, safety or housing standards in the subject apartment or
23 in the common areas of the subject building or any hazardous violations
24 of record of any applicable state, city or local codes relating to hous-
25 ing maintenance, safety or housing standards in or pertaining to any
26 building in the landlord's portfolio, a landlord may commence a proceed-
27 ing under this subdivision by filing, with the petition and notice of
28 petition prescribed by section seven hundred thirty-one of this article,
29 an affirmation including facts establishing that the landlord has
30 corrected any purported conditions contained in the tenant declaration
31 of housing conditions, or that the conditions specified in the tenant
32 declaration of housing conditions never existed or that any violations
33 were placed erroneously by a state, city, or local agency, or that a
34 state, city or local agency, authority or department erroneously failed
35 to remove such violations after they were corrected.

36 (c) Failure by the landlord to disclose an existing violation of
37 record of any applicable state, city or local codes relating to housing
38 maintenance, safety or housing standards or any condition that otherwise
39 contravenes section two hundred thirty-five-b of the real property law
40 in the subject premises or in the common areas of the subject building,
41 or hazardous conditions or hazardous violations of record of any appli-
42 cable state, city or local codes relating to housing maintenance, safety
43 or housing standards in any building in the landlord's portfolio subject
44 to paragraph (b) of this subdivision herein, or an existing tenant
45 declaration of housing conditions is grounds for dismissal. If the court
46 finds that the allegations in such a landlord affirmation are untrue
47 regarding the correction or nonexistence of conditions in a tenant
48 declaration of housing conditions or regarding a corrected or erroneously
49 recorded violation of any applicable state, city, or local codes
50 related to housing maintenance, safety, or housing standards and condi-
51 tions, this is grounds for dismissal.

52 (d) For the purposes of this section, the following terms shall have
53 the following meanings:

54 (i) "Hazardous conditions" shall mean those housing conditions that
55 have a serious effect on the life, health, or safety of the occupants
56 thereof. These conditions may include, but are not strictly limited to,

cockroach, bedbug, rat, mouse, or other vermin infestations, mold, lead-based paint, essential utility shut-off (i.e., natural gas, heat, running water, electricity, or adequate sewage disposal facilities), defective emergency exits, leaking or defective water supply plumbing, defective plumbing facility, leaking or collapsed roof, inoperable carbon monoxide detector, or inoperable smoke detector.

(ii) "Landlord's portfolio" shall mean the collection of all housing accommodations of which the beneficial owner of the premises at issue in the proceeding is a beneficial owner, directly or indirectly, in whole or in part, jointly or separately, excluding each natural person owner's principal residence. For purposes of this subparagraph, a beneficial owner shall mean a natural person who owns or controls not less than twenty-five percent of the housing accommodation or, if the landlord is an entity, a natural person who exercises substantial control over said entity or owns or controls not less than twenty-five percent of the ownership interests of the entity.

(e) A tenant declaration of housing conditions shall be used by tenants and occupants to provide notification at any time that at least one condition that contravenes section two hundred thirty-five-b of the real property law or any applicable state, city or local codes relating to housing maintenance, safety or housing standards exists in the subject premises or in the common areas of the subject building or that at least one hazardous condition exists in any building in the landlord's portfolio subject to paragraph (b) of this subdivision herein. A tenant or occupant shall file a signed tenant declaration of housing conditions form with the court that is the lawful venue for a proceeding filed pursuant to this article with respect to their dwelling, and shall also provide a copy of the filing to their landlord at the address designated on their multiple dwelling registration.

(f) Nothing in subdivision one of this section shall prevent eviction proceedings from being commenced or shall cause eviction proceedings to be stayed if the tenant is persistently and unreasonably engaging in behavior that substantially infringes on the use and enjoyment of other tenants or occupants or that causes a substantial safety hazard to others, provided if an eviction proceeding is pending at the effective date of this provision, but the petitioner has not previously alleged that the tenant persistently and unreasonably engaged in such behavior in said proceeding, the petitioner shall be required to submit a new petition with such allegations and comply with all notice and service requirements pursuant to this article.

2. (a) The tenant has defaulted in the payment of rent, pursuant to the agreement under which the premises are held, and a written demand of the rent has been made with at least fourteen days' notice requiring, in the alternative, the payment of the rent, or the possession of the premises, has been served upon the tenant as prescribed in section seven hundred thirty-five of this article, and at the time of commencement of the proceeding there are no violations of record of any applicable state, city or local codes relating to housing maintenance, safety or housing standards pertaining to the subject premises or in the common areas of the subject building, nor any conditions that otherwise contravene section two hundred thirty-five-b of the real property law in the subject premises or in the common areas of the subject building, nor any tenant declaration of housing conditions declaring conditions that contravene section two hundred thirty-five-b of the real property law or that violate any applicable state, city or local codes relating to housing maintenance, safety or housing standards, in the subject premises or

1 in the common areas of the subject building or that are hazardous condi-
2 tions in the landlord's portfolio herein subject to paragraph (b) of
3 subdivision one of this section, nor any conditions that are hazardous
4 violations of any applicable state, city or local codes relating to
5 housing maintenance, safety or housing standards or hazardous conditions
6 in any building in the landlord's portfolio.

7 (b) The fourteen-day notice shall append or contain the notice
8 required pursuant to section two hundred thirty-one-c of the real prop-
9 erty law, which shall state the following: (i) if the premises are or
10 are not subject to article six-A of the real property law, the "good
11 cause eviction law", and if the premises are exempt, such notice shall
12 state why the premises are exempt from such law; (ii) if the landlord is
13 not renewing the lease for a unit subject to article six-A of the real
14 property law, the lawful basis for such non-renewal; and (iii) if the
15 landlord is increasing the rent upon an existing lease of a unit subject
16 to article six-A of the real property law above the applicable local
17 rent standard, as defined in subdivision eight of section two hundred
18 eleven of the real property law, the justification for such increase.
19 Any person succeeding to the landlord's interest in the premises may
20 proceed under this subdivision for rent due such person's predecessor in
21 interest if such person has a right thereto. Where a tenant dies during
22 the term of the lease and rent due has not been paid and the apartment
23 is occupied by a person with a claim to possession, a proceeding may be
24 commenced naming the occupants of the apartment seeking a possessory
25 judgment only as against the estate. Entry of such a judgment shall be
26 without prejudice to the possessory claims of the occupants, and any
27 warrant issued shall not be effective as against the occupants.

28 § 1-a. Subdivision 2 of section 711 of the real property actions and
29 proceedings law, as amended by section 12 of part M of chapter 36 of the
30 laws of 2019, is amended to read as follows:

31 2. (a) The tenant has defaulted in the payment of rent, pursuant to
32 the agreement under which the premises are held, and a written demand of
33 the rent has been made with at least fourteen days' notice requiring, in
34 the alternative, the payment of the rent, or the possession of the prem-
35 ises, has been served upon [him] such tenant as prescribed in section
36 seven hundred thirty-five of this article, and at the time of commence-
37 ment of the proceeding there are no violations of record of any applica-
38 ble state, city or local codes relating to housing maintenance, safety
39 or housing standards pertaining to the subject premises or in the common
40 areas of the subject building, nor any conditions that otherwise contra-
41 vene section two hundred thirty-five-b of the real property law in the
42 subject premises or in the common areas of the subject building, nor any
43 tenant declaration of housing conditions declaring conditions that
44 contravene section two hundred thirty-five-b of the real property law or
45 that violate any applicable state, city or local codes relating to hous-
46 ing maintenance, safety or housing standards in the subject premises or
47 in the common areas of the subject building that are hazardous condi-
48 tions in any building in the landlord's portfolio subject to paragraph
49 (b) of subdivision one of this section herein, nor any conditions that
50 are hazardous conditions of any applicable state, city or local codes
51 relating to housing maintenance, safety or housing standards or hazard-
52 ous violations in any building in the landlord's portfolio.

53 (b) Any person succeeding to the landlord's interest in the premises
54 may proceed under this subdivision for rent due [his] the predecessor in
55 interest if [he] such person has a right thereto. Where a tenant dies
56 during the term of the lease and rent due has not been paid and the

1 apartment is occupied by a person with a claim to possession, a proceed-
2 ing may be commenced naming the occupants of the apartment seeking a
3 possessory judgment only as against the estate. Entry of such a judgment
4 shall be without prejudice to the possessory claims of the occupants,
5 and any warrant issued shall not be effective as against the occupants.

6 (c) Where a tenant declaration of housing conditions has been filed
7 with the landlord and the court that is the lawful venue for a special
8 proceeding under this subdivision, or where there exist any violations
9 of record of any applicable state, city or local codes relating to hous-
10 ing maintenance, safety or housing standards in the subject apartment or
11 in the common areas of the subject building or any hazardous violations
12 of record of any applicable state, city or local codes relating to hous-
13 ing maintenance, safety or housing standards in or pertaining to any
14 building in the landlord's portfolio, a landlord may commence a proceed-
15 ing under this subdivision by filing, with the petition and notice of
16 petition prescribed by section seven hundred thirty-one of this article,
17 an affirmation including facts establishing that the landlord has
18 corrected any purported conditions contained in the tenant declaration
19 of housing conditions, or that the conditions specified in the tenant
20 declaration of housing conditions never existed or that any violations
21 were placed erroneously by a state, city, or local agency, or that a
22 state, city or local agency, authority or department erroneously failed
23 to remove such violations after they were corrected.

24 (d) Failure by the landlord to disclose an existing violation of
25 record of any applicable state, city or local codes relating to housing
26 maintenance, safety or housing standards or any condition that otherwise
27 contravenes section two hundred thirty-five-b of the real property law
28 in the subject premises or in the common areas of the subject building,
29 or hazardous conditions or hazardous violations of record of any appli-
30 cable state, city or local codes relating to housing maintenance, safety
31 or housing standards in any building in the landlord's portfolio subject
32 to paragraph (b) of subdivision one of this section herein, or an exist-
33 ing tenant declaration of housing conditions is grounds for dismissal.
34 If the court finds that the allegations in such a landlord affirmation
35 are untrue regarding the correction or nonexistence of conditions in a
36 tenant declaration of housing conditions or regarding a corrected or
37 erroneously recorded violation of any applicable state, city, or local
38 codes related to housing maintenance, safety, or housing standards and
39 conditions, this is grounds for dismissal.

40 (e) A tenant declaration of housing conditions shall be used by
41 tenants and occupants to provide notification at any time that at least
42 one condition that contravenes section two hundred thirty-five-b of the
43 real property law or any applicable state, city or local codes relating
44 to housing maintenance, safety or housing standards exists in the
45 subject premises or in the common areas of the subject building or that
46 at least one hazardous condition exists in any building in the land-
47 lord's portfolio subject to paragraph (b) of subdivision one of this
48 section herein. A tenant or occupant shall file a signed tenant declara-
49 tion of housing conditions form with the court that is the lawful venue
50 for a proceeding filed pursuant to this article with respect to their
51 dwelling, and shall also provide a copy of the filing to their landlord
52 at the address designated on their multiple dwelling registration.

53 § 2. Section 741 of the real property actions and proceedings law is
54 amended by adding a new subdivision 3-a to read as follows:

55 3-a. State in the landlord affirmation that at the time of commence-
56 ment of the proceeding that there are no violations of record of any

1 applicable state, city or local codes relating to housing maintenance,
2 safety or housing standards in the subject premises or common areas of
3 the building nor any tenant declaration of housing conditions declaring
4 conditions that contravene section two hundred thirty-five-b of the real
5 property law in the subject premises or in the common areas of the
6 subject building or hazardous conditions as such term is defined in
7 paragraph (d) of subdivision one of section seven hundred eleven of this
8 article in or pertaining to any building in the landlord's portfolio as
9 such term is defined in paragraph (d) of subdivision one of section
10 seven hundred eleven of this article subject to paragraph (b) of subdivi-
11 vision one of section seven hundred eleven of this article herein, nor
12 any hazardous conditions as such term is defined in paragraph (d) of
13 subdivision one of section seven hundred eleven of this article or
14 hazardous violations of record of any applicable state, city or local
15 codes relating to housing maintenance, safety or housing standards in or
16 pertaining to any building in the landlord's portfolio as such term is
17 defined in paragraph (d) of subdivision one of section seven hundred
18 eleven of this article.

19 § 3. The real property action and proceedings law is amended by adding
20 a new section 752 to read as follows:

21 § 752. Stay of proceeding or action for nonpayment and holdover cases
22 upon a finding of existing violations. 1. Upon court discovery of any
23 new violations of record of any applicable state, city or local codes
24 relating to housing maintenance, safety or housing standards in the
25 subject apartment or in the common areas of the subject building, or any
26 hazardous conditions as defined by paragraph (d) of subdivision one of
27 section seven hundred eleven of this article or hazardous violations of
28 record of any applicable state, city or local codes relating to housing
29 maintenance, safety or housing standards in any building in the land-
30 lord's portfolio as defined by paragraph (d) of subdivision one of
31 section seven hundred eleven of this article arising after the commence-
32 ment of the proceeding a stay shall be granted and remain in effect only
33 until the condition or violation is corrected consistent with what is
34 required by law.

35 2. Upon court receipt of any new tenant declaration of housing condi-
36 tions filed at any time thereafter the commencement of the proceeding, a
37 stay shall be granted and remain in effect only until the condition is
38 corrected consistent with what is required by law.

39 § 4. This act shall take effect immediately; provided, however, that
40 the amendments to subdivision 2 of section 711 of the real property
41 actions and proceedings law made by section one of this act shall be
42 subject to the expiration and reversion of such subdivision pursuant to
43 section 7 of part HH of chapter 56 of the laws of 2024, as amended, when
44 upon such date the provisions of section one-a of this act shall take
45 effect.